

A/An: the indefinite article

CEFR A2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Use a/an with a singular countable noun. Main uses:

- 1 One of many, or first mention — I need a pen; A man called earlier.
- 2 Jobs and roles — He's a teacher; She works as an engineer.
- 3 Meaning 'one' — a kilo, a week, an hour.

Never use a/an with plurals or uncountables: not 'a shoes', not 'an advice'. Choose a or an by sound.

At a glance

Use	Example
First mention	I read a book about Rome.
One of many	Can I have a chair?
Jobs and roles	She's an engineer.
Meaning 'one'	Wait a minute.
Exclamations	What a view!

Learning objectives

- Can use a/an with singular countable nouns for first mention and 'one of many' (CEFR A2).
- Can use a/an before jobs and in common expressions.
- Can avoid a/an with plural and uncountable nouns.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. A/An: the indefinite article · CEFR A2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. My mother is ____ doctor.

- | | |
|------|--------|
| A. a | B. the |
| C. — | D. an |

2. I need ____ new phone; mine is broken.

- | | |
|-------|--------|
| A. a | B. the |
| C. an | D. — |

3. Can you give me ____ information about the course?

- | | |
|---------|--------|
| A. an | B. a |
| C. some | D. the |

4. We go to the gym twice ____ week.

- | | |
|-------|--------|
| A. a | B. the |
| C. an | D. in |

5. Which is correct?

- | | |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| A. I bought a new shoes. | B. I bought new shoes. |
| C. I bought an new shoes. | D. I bought a news shoes. |

6. What ____ beautiful day!

- | | |
|-------|--------|
| A. a | B. the |
| C. an | D. — |

7. He works as ____ engineer.

- | | |
|--------|------|
| A. an | B. a |
| C. the | D. — |

8. Correct this: 'She gave me an advice.'

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| A. She gave me some advice. | B. She gave me a advice. |
| C. She gave me an advices. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

9. There's ____ message for you on the desk.

- | | |
|--------|-------|
| A. a | B. an |
| C. the | D. — |

10. When do you use a/an?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A. With a singular countable noun that is non-specific. | B. With plural nouns talking in general. |
| C. With uncountable nouns like water. | D. When the noun is specific and known. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. a** — Use a/an before a job: 'a doctor'.
2. **A. a** — First mention, one of many: 'a new phone'.
3. **C. some** — Use 'some' with an uncountable noun: 'some information'.
4. **A. a** — 'a' means 'per' here: 'twice a week'.
5. **B. I bought new shoes.** — Plurals take no a/an: 'I bought new shoes'.
6. **A. a** — Exclamations with a singular countable noun use 'a': 'What a beautiful day!'
7. **A. an** — 'Engineer' starts with a vowel sound → 'an engineer'.
8. **A. She gave me some advice.** — 'Advice' is uncountable: 'some advice' (or 'a piece of advice').
9. **A. a** — First mention, singular countable: 'a message'.
10. **A. With a singular countable noun that is non-specific.** — a/an goes with a singular countable, non-specific noun.